

HABBINSON

PERSONALITY & ENTREPRENEURSHIP SCHOOL

— PARENT INTELLIGENCE REPORT

What to do when school labels your child

Every child learns differently — and school doesn't always see it. Learn why "slow" labels are so often wrong, and 5 ways to teach to your child's real strengths.

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THE CHALLENGE PARENTS FACE

Every child learns differently, but a report card rarely says so. It says "below average," or "not trying," or "slow." And if you've ever sat at a parent meeting with your stomach in a knot, hearing your bright, funny kid described as a problem, you know how much those words can sting — and how wrong they can be.

— THE 30-SECOND ANSWER

What to do when school labels your child

QUICK ANSWER

What does "every child learns differently" mean? It means children take in, process, and show what they know in different ways and on different timelines. One child reads early; another talks late but builds beautifully. A struggle in one school subject doesn't define a child's intelligence. The job of a parent is to find and feed each child's real strengths, not force them all through one mould.

DO THIS

5 ways to teach a child who learns differently

Work through these in order. Small, consistent reps beat one big push.

1**Notice the "how." Does your child learn**

by doing, by talking, by drawing, by moving? Lean into whatever gets them leaning in.

2**Teach to a strength to fix a weakness**

A child who loves cricket can learn maths through scores and averages.

3**Break big tasks into small wins**

Confidence is built one tiny success at a time, not one giant leap.

4**Drop the comparisons**

Measure your child against last week's self, never against the kid next door.

5**Never repeat a label**

Refuse to call your child "slow" — at home, that word does not exist.

— KEEP AN EYE OUT

The hidden cost of the "slow" label

- ✓ A child who's told they're "slow" starts to avoid the very subjects they could grow in.
- ✓ One bad fit with a teacher or method gets mistaken for a permanent lack of ability.
- ✓ Real strengths — creativity, curiosity, hands-on skill — go unnoticed because they're not on the test.
- ✓ Confidence drops, and a discouraged child learns far slower than a curious one.

— COMMON QUESTIONS

Quick answers for parents

What does it mean that every child learns differently?

It means children absorb and show knowledge in different ways and on different timelines. One reads early, another is hands-on, another talks things through. A struggle in one subject doesn't measure a child's intelligence. The parent's job is to find each child's strengths and teach through them.

My child was called "slow" at school — should I worry?

One classroom verdict is not your child's ceiling. A poor fit with a method or teacher is often mistaken for a lack of ability. Look at how your child learns best, feed their strengths, and get a proper assessment if you're concerned — but don't let a single label define them.

Was Thomas Edison really a poor student?

Yes. By many accounts Edison was sent home early in his schooling, with a teacher calling him "addled." His mother taught him at home, following his curiosity. He went on to become one of history's most prolific inventors — a powerful reminder that early labels are often wrong.

How do I find out how my child learns best?

Watch what pulls them in. Notice whether they learn by doing, talking, drawing, or moving, and which subjects they lose track of time in. Then offer new material in that channel. Since every child learns differently, close observation tells you more than any generic test.

How can I help a child who learns differently keep their confidence?

Protect their belief that they can grow. Break tasks into small wins, praise effort over results, stop comparisons with other kids, and never repeat a "slow" label at home. A confident child takes on hard things; a discouraged one gives up before trying.

Does learning differently mean my child has a learning disability?

Not necessarily. Many children simply develop at their own pace or have a different mix of strengths. Some do have specific learning differences that benefit from support. If you see a persistent, significant gap, ask a professional — but learning differently is normal, not a diagnosis.

READING HELPS. PRACTICE STICKS.

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